Tobias Treppmann

Target role: Senior Design Systems Manager · design systems in code · AI-assisted tooling · design leadership

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PROFILE

I'm a product and design leader who ships production code. I build design systems in code for AI-assisted work: at Bibel TV, four token tiers served as an API, with build checks refusing off-system values. At Ninox I led five direct reports, owned the design system and established joint governance with engineering.

Prototype to code	95–100% of Android design-system code (release 6.0, beta) from my prototype
4-tier token API	built so a design change skips the app release
5 direct reports	Ninox design team; owned the design system

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design
2025 – Present

Bibel TV (streaming apps on iOS, Android, web and connected TV) *Hamburg + Berlin, Germany*

- Built a four-tier design-token architecture delivered as an API (primitives → semantic → component → page/view). Design parameters come from the server, so a design change skips the app release process.
- Built a design system for AI-assisted work: Storybook as source of truth, a closed token vocabulary for Claude, and checks, identical locally and in CI, refusing unresolved tokens or hardcoded component values.
- Exposed the system to coding agents through a design-system MCP and CLI.
- 64% of the code behind the redesigned Home and detail views of the Bibel TV Android app (release 6.0, in beta) comes verbatim from my prototype.
- Engineering builds from my prototype code: for the design system and tokens it is 95–100%.
- Product manager and product owner for the app redesign initiative. Enabled product managers and owners to adopt AI: Claude Code, Spec Kit, MCP servers, one-on-one sessions. Far more is now built in-house.
- Built a live color API: an OKLCH engine that computes a readable theme from each video's artwork and checks contrast for light and dark themes.

Head of Platform and Design
2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical SaaS for churches across six European markets) *Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin*

- Ran the European Accessibility Act audit myself, testing the product and website builder against WCAG AA. Both findings were fixed and shipped: AI alt-text generation and calendar colors redesigned for contrast.
- Embedded booking in the platform instead of the planned add-on module: an estimated 70% less coordination effort, 90% booking acceptance, then released to all customers.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product
2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform across DACH, the UK and the US) *Berlin, Germany*

- Led a design team of five direct reports across product design and UX writing, with my own leveling framework and individual growth plans; hired two and promoted two. Senior Leadership Team member.
- Owned the design system, consolidated and grew it, and established joint governance with engineering, with Storybook and Figma Variables.
- Led the team in designing components with real translations wherever possible.
- Owned capacity, allocation, team structure and processes for design; when Ninox shifted into new product development, moved one designer to the new product first.
- Led Product and Design together for four months, nine people across both functions.

Director of Design
2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (enterprise data analytics for regulated banks and insurers) *Berlin · team across Germany and New York*

- Led the UX team (2 reports) in a design organization across Germany and New York, partnering with product and engineering leaders as a functional head.
- Defined component behavior and specifications for the co-built design system.
- Reoriented to the new product: when Datameer moved into new product development, design entered roadmap conversations and the whole design team made the new product its priority.

UX Strategy Lead

2014 – 2016

Spreadshirt (print-on-demand marketplace for about 5,000 sellers and hundreds of thousands of consumers) *Leipzig, Germany*

- Influenced leadership with user research: shop-owner research moved the product from a full automation vision to a balanced approach during a nine-month seller experience redesign.
- Commissioned a seller analysis: a new seller's first design took 90 days to sell, against expectations of fast money. The seller journey was planned around making success criteria transparent.
- Prototyped and user-tested a mobile designer that went into production.

CURRENT PRODUCT PRACTICE

Independent product work alongside employed roles.

Selah for macOS — Independent product
Designed and agentically engineered a Mac app on the Mac App Store.

AI Bible study app for Bibel TV — In development
Designed and built an iOS and Android app with a web sibling, chat and retrieval over sermon videos; runs in test builds.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Product & UX Strategist · *Hypoport hub SE* · 2021 – 2022 · Berlin / Lübeck · design-thinking training for executive leadership and service teams

Independent Product Design Consultant · *Oratio&Co* · 2016 – Present · Remote · product strategy, UX direction and working prototypes

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · one-on-one mentoring of more than 100 career changers into UX design

UX Manager & Product Designer · *US consumer e-commerce* · 2009 – 2014 · Pennsylvania, USA · hand-written HTML, CSS and JavaScript

EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership
Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Design systems in code

Four-tier design tokens (DTCG) · token API · Storybook as source of truth · component libraries · Figma Variables · token quality checks in CI · per-video theming from an OKLCH color engine · governance with engineering

AI-assisted tooling

Claude Code · design-system MCP and CLI · closed token vocabularies for coding agents · GitHub with Spec Kit · generative AI features with chat and retrieval over sermon videos · enabling product managers and owners to build with AI

Design leadership

Leveling framework · individual growth plans · hiring and promotion · capacity allocation · team structure and ways of working · human-centered approach · Senior Leadership Team · product management and product ownership

Accessibility and localization

WCAG AA testing · European Accessibility Act audit · contrast checks in code · components designed with real translations

Frontend, backend and engineering collaboration

HTML · CSS · JavaScript · React prototypes built with AI coding agents · app backend with Postgres and pgvector · Git and GitHub · component specifications · implementation review

Languages and location

German native · English C2 · Berlin-based